

Stress Test Quick Reference

Your turn

1. **Refresh:** committed lines and talent become available.
2. **Settle:** pay interest; collect Yield (Surplus, or a card from cards that pay in cards); pay carrying costs on treaties and lines in Surplus or discard (the total rounds down); next stage of each developing event.
3. **Draw 1.** A Forecast card is shown to the table and can't be run this turn.
4. **Operate:** write 1 line (gain Margin); 1 talent move (hire or poach); play investments, treaties, covers; run scenarios; use abilities.
5. **Close:** margin call (keep 1 Margin Credit per 10 Surplus); discard to 8; others may run 1 Breaking scenario each.

The first-player marker passes left every round. Opening hand: 6 cards, one redraw.

Money

- **Leverage:** commit a line for 1; committed cards are available again next turn (on paper, slide them forward); unspent Leverage is lost.
- **Surplus:** your capital. 0 or less $\Rightarrow$ insolvent.
- **Margin:** +1 Surplus per exposure on a line you write.
- **Hire:** pay Surplus. **Poach:** Hire cost + 2 Surplus; the poached employee gains Non-compete and arrives committed (gardening leave).
- **Liquidate** any time: Sale value as Leverage or Surplus.
- **Fire Sale:** after a sale by a company under 10 Surplus, everyone under 15 sells that investment for half its Sale value, rounded down.

Running a scenario

1. Pay Leverage; choose the target if needed. **Focus:** pay 2 more, pick one opponent, it loses double.
2. **Response window:** left of you first, you last. Responses, committed talent, liquidation. No responses to responses.
3. **Stop:** the runner pays the extra Leverage the card names, or the scenario is called off. An Act of God can't be stopped.
4. **Resolve,** then check insolvency.

A free Bank Run (Emergency Equity Infusion) is run in full at once, never Focused; then the scenario it interrupted picks up again. Everything Is Securities Fraud: when the scenario ends, its target loses what scenarios have cost it this round, again.

Financials (banks and funds)

- **Retail Deposits:** Short-Term Rates exposure, except a third of them (rounded down), which have none; a bank run takes half, rounded down, counting Venture Deposits and Evergreen Credit with them.

- **Investor Capital:** Short-Term Equity exposure.
- **Private Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost $1\frac{1}{2}$.
- **Margin Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost 1; margin call at the end of your turn.
- **Loans** (Credit Cards, Mortgage Lending, Prime Brokerage) are investments with a Credit exposure.

Drawing and discarding

Extra draws come from lines you write, Responses you play, and investments or employees at the start of your turn. When a card makes you discard, you choose which cards, face up. An empty deck just stops drawing.

Who gets hit

Each opponent (not you; with Focus, one of them for double) · **Target opponent** · **Systemic** (you too)

Loss math

Clause amount $\times$ (exposures – hedges, min 0). **x2** counts twice. Nat Cat: Any matches every Nat Cat peril. Focused: double each clause.

Protection order: failed programs (“Destroyed if”) $\rightarrow$ covers and ignores $\rightarrow$ halving $\rightarrow$ flat reductions $\rightarrow$ swap payments $\rightarrow$ responses and talent $\rightarrow$ XoL cap $\rightarrow$ recoveries.

Insolvency

Auto-sell liquid investments. Still at 0 or less: out. Too Big to Fail makes a failure cost everyone else 5 Surplus.

Table size

Players	2	3	4	5
Starting Surplus	16	18	25	28

Game ends after round 10: most Surplus wins.

Keywords

Forecast shown when drawn or searched for, not runnable that turn. **Act of God** can't be stopped. **Breaking** runnable at the end of another player's turn. **Developing Event** stage 1 now, one more each turn; turn the card a quarter turn per stage. **Systemic** hits you too. **Focus** pay 2 more to hit one opponent for double; other effects once. **Illiquid** can't be sold. **Non-compete** can't be poached. **CEO** starts in play; never poached or fired. **Dark** evidence once in your discard pile; reckonings charge per piece, and nothing removes it.